

Division: Group Size or Group Count?

Directions

- A division answer counts **one** of two things: how many are **in each group** (the group size), or **how many groups** there are (the group count).
- Before you write an answer, ask: *what does this number count?*
- Some problems show another student's thinking with a mistake in it. Find the mistake and fix it.

1. Amara bakes 12 cookies and shares them equally into 3 gift bags. How many cookies go in each bag?

Answer: _____

2. A coach has 15 tennis balls and packs 5 balls into each can. How many cans does the coach fill?

Answer: _____

3. Dev puts 20 grapes equally onto 4 snack plates. How many grapes are on each plate?

Answer: _____

4. There are 24 crayons shared equally among 6 boxes. Jo says: “Each box holds 6 crayons, because the 6 is right there in the problem.”

(a) What went wrong in Jo’s thinking?

(b) How many crayons are really in each box?

Answer: _____

5. A toy maker has 28 wheels. Each wagon needs 4 wheels. How many wagons can the toy maker build?

Answer: _____

6. Rin has 18 stickers and shares them equally between 2 friends.

How many stickers does each friend get? _____

Now say what your answer counts: the number of friends, or the number of stickers each friend gets?

7. Ben has 30 marbles and puts 5 marbles in each pouch. He writes $30 \div 5 = 6$ and says: “So each pouch holds 6 marbles.”

(a) Name the mistake in what Ben said. (His division is correct!)

(b) What does the 6 really count — how many pouches does Ben fill?

Answer: _____

8. **Challenge.** Write two different division stories for $24 \div 4$.

(a) A story where the answer tells how many are **in each group**.

(b) A story where the answer tells **how many groups** there are.

(c) What is $24 \div 4$? _____